MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-B.VOC (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATIONS, April 2026

SECOND SEMESTER

ANSWER KEY

Skill Development Components (SDC) – MG2SDCBAJ100
INTRODUCTION TO DIGITAL PHOTOGRAPHY
(2025 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration : 1 hour 30 minutes Maximum Marks : 50

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Part A
MCQ
Answer all questions
Each question carries 1 mark

1. a) Film
2. b) It was cheaper than painted portraits
3. d) Combined a camera and phone in one device
4. a) Fixed focal length
5. b) Creates visual balance and interest
6. a) Tagged Image File Format
7. d) Blur the background and highlight subject
8. b) Doors, windows, and tree branches
9. b) Redirecting existing light toward the subject
10. c) Soft and warm in tone

Part B
Short Answers
Answer any 5 questions
Each question carries 2 marks

11. Name the first permanent photograph

The first permanent photograph is **"View from the Window at Le Gras."** It was taken by Joseph Nicéphore Niépce. It is considered the earliest surviving photograph in history.

---

12. What are the basic items to carry for a photography shoot?

Basic items include a camera, lenses, memory cards, and extra batteries. A tripod helps to keep the camera steady. A cleaning kit and camera bag are also important for protection and maintenance.

---

13. Define macro photography

Macro photography is the photography of very small subjects at a very close distance. It helps to capture fine details that are not visible to the naked eye. It is commonly used for insects, flowers, and textures.

---

14. Define white balance

White balance is the process of adjusting colours in a photograph. It helps to make white objects appear natural under different lighting conditions. It removes unwanted colour tones from the image.

---

15. Why are communication skills important for photographers?

Communication skills help photographers interact clearly with clients and subjects. They can give proper instructions during a shoot. Good communication helps in understanding requirements and achieving better results.

---

16. What is pre-production in photography?

Pre-production is the planning stage before a photography shoot. It includes selecting location, lighting, equipment, and concept. Proper planning helps to achieve better and organised results.

---

17. Mention two advantages of soft light in portrait photography

Soft light reduces harsh shadows on the face. It creates smooth and natural skin tones. It also improves the overall appearance of the subject.

---

18. What is the purpose of self-timer mode?

Self-timer mode allows a delay before taking a photograph. It helps the photographer to be part of the picture. It also reduces camera shake and improves image stability.

Part C
Short Essay
Answer any 3 questions
Each question carries 5 marks

19. Explain the role of photography in advertising and media promotion.

Photography plays a very important role in advertising and media promotion because it helps to attract the attention of the audience quickly. A good photograph can communicate a message more effectively than words. In advertising, images are used to present products in an attractive and appealing way so that customers feel interested in buying them. In media, photographs support news stories and provide visual proof of events. They help the audience to understand information easily and quickly. Photography also helps in building brand identity and improving marketing strategies. Therefore, it is a powerful tool for communication, promotion, and visual storytelling.

---

20. How would you use natural light effectively for portrait photography?

Natural light can be used effectively in portrait photography by choosing the right time and position. Early morning and evening are the best times because the light is soft and warm. The subject should be positioned facing the light to get even illumination on the face. Harsh midday sunlight should be avoided as it creates strong shadows. Reflectors can be used to bounce light and reduce dark areas. Shooting near windows can also provide soft indoor lighting. By controlling direction and intensity of natural light, photographers can create beautiful and natural-looking portraits.

---

21. Explain the relationship between aperture and light.

Aperture is the opening in the camera lens that controls the amount of light entering the camera. A wide aperture (low f-number) allows more light to enter, making the image brighter. A narrow aperture (high f-number) allows less light, making the image darker. Aperture also affects depth of field, which controls how much of the image is in focus. Therefore, it plays both a technical and creative role in photography. By adjusting aperture, photographers can control brightness as well as background blur. Thus, aperture is directly related to light and exposure.

---

22. Explain how mass production changed the history of photography.

Mass production played a major role in the development of photography by making cameras affordable and accessible to common people. Earlier, cameras were expensive and used only by professionals. With the introduction of mass production by companies like Kodak, cameras became cheaper and easy to use. This allowed ordinary people to take photographs in their daily life. Photography became more popular and widely used for personal, social, and commercial purposes. It also helped in the growth of industries like advertising and media. Therefore, mass production made photography a common and important part of modern life.

---

23. Describe common challenges faced in photography.

Photographers often face many challenges while taking pictures. Poor lighting conditions can make images too dark or too bright. Camera shake can cause blur, especially in low light. Wrong exposure settings may affect image quality. Weather conditions like rain, fog, or strong sunlight can also create problems. Managing subjects and composition can be difficult, especially in crowded or dynamic situations. Technical knowledge and experience are needed to overcome these challenges. Therefore, practice and proper understanding of equipment are important for successful photography.

Part D
Essay
Answer any 1 question
Each question carries 15 marks

24. Explain how smartphone cameras have changed modern photography and journalism

Smartphone cameras have greatly changed modern photography and journalism by making image capturing easy and accessible to everyone. Earlier, photography required expensive cameras and technical knowledge, but now smartphones allow anyone to take high-quality photos instantly. This has increased the number of photographers and visual content creators.

In photography, smartphones offer features like autofocus, HDR, portrait mode, and editing tools, which help users capture and improve images easily. They are portable and always available, making it convenient to capture moments anytime. Social media platforms have also increased the sharing of photographs, making photography more popular.

In journalism, smartphone cameras have played a major role in citizen journalism. People can capture real-time events and share them instantly with the world. This helps in faster news reporting and wider coverage. Journalists also use smartphones for quick reporting, live updates, and multimedia storytelling.

However, smartphone photography also has limitations such as lower quality compared to professional cameras in some conditions and issues related to fake or manipulated images.

Despite this, smartphones have made photography and journalism faster, easier, and more accessible.

Thus, smartphone cameras have revolutionized modern photography and journalism by changing how images are captured, shared, and used in communication.

---

25. Discuss how photography communicates ideas, emotions, and information

Photography is a powerful medium that communicates ideas, emotions, and information visually. A photograph can convey a message without using words. It captures real-life moments and presents them in a way that people can easily understand.

Photography expresses emotions such as happiness, sadness, fear, and excitement through facial expressions, lighting, and composition. It helps viewers connect emotionally with the subject. In journalism, photographs provide important information about events, people, and places. They support news stories and make them more realistic and impactful.

In media and society, photography plays a key role in advertising, education, and social awareness. Images are used to promote products, spread messages, and create awareness about social issues. They influence opinions and shape public understanding.

Lighting, angle, colour, and composition all help in conveying meaning in a photograph. A well-composed image can tell a complete story. Therefore, photography is not just about taking pictures but about communicating ideas effectively.

Thus, photography is an important tool in modern media and society as it connects people, informs them, and expresses emotions in a powerful way.